1

Date:
Day:

Q: **Under Trump, trade which was supposed to be a tool for peaceful growth has been turned into an instrument of war without violence, to counter the growing economic might of new powers. Do you agree with this statement? Discuss in detail.**

Introduction:

In earlier decades, international trade was largely viewed as a driver of economic growth and interdependence. However, in the contemporary global order, trade has increasingly been weaponized as a strategic tool of statecraft. Major powers particularly, The United States under President Trump, employed trade policy to protect domestic industries, reduce trade deficits, bring manufacturing jobs back to America, and counter China's growing economic and technological influence. Through tariffs and trade barriers US sought to slow the rise of emerging powers, limit BRI, and preserve its strategic dominance in evolving multipolar world.

Date: Day:

2. Trade as a tool for war to counter the growing economic might of new Powers:

2.1 Protection of Domestic Industry through America First Narrative:

The central pillar of Trump's trade policy was the America's First Narrative, which emphasized economic nationalism and protectionism. The administration imposed tariffs to protect local industries from foreign competition, particularly in steel, aluminium and manufacturing sectors.

2.2 Bringing Jobs Back to the United States:

Trade war objective also include, restoring employment in the U.S manufacturing sectors. Trump argued that globalisation and free trade agreements had led to jobs losses and outsourcing. By restricting imports and encouraging companies to manufacture at their own,

Date: Day:

the trade war was sought to repatriate jobs in America.

2.3 To bridge trade deficit between US and China:

Realist focus more on relative gains than absolute gains. Trump viewed that the U.S.-China trade deficit as evidence that China was benefiting more from trade then the U.S. The imposition of tariffs aimed to rebalence trade relations and prevent China from gaining more advantages.

2.4 To counter China's hegemony in Tech Sector:

US targeted China's rapid growth in high technology Sector such as AI, 5G, and semiconductors. By restricting Chinease techonology firms and limiting technology transfers, the U.S aimed to slow China's rise as a global technological leader and to preserve its dominance in innovation industries.

Date: Day:

2.5 **Preventing the Emergence of a Multipolar World Order:**

China's economic expansion imposed a challenge to US global dominance. Trump imposed tariffs to slow down China's rise and to prevent the shift toward a multipolar or bipolar world order.

2.6 **Countering Russia and De-dollarization Efforts:**

Trump's economic strategy also had implications for Russia's growing influence, particularly its attempts to promote de-dollarization and reduce reliance on U.S dollar. Through economic pressure and sanctions, the U.S aimed to limit Russia resurgence as a global power.

2.7 **Disrupting Global Supply Chains of Rising Powers:**

Tariffs force foreign companies to reconsider supply chains, reducing the efficiency and profits of emerging powers. For instance China had to absorb higher costs and relocate production, which could slow down its economic rise.

2.8 Tariffs as a Strategic Deterrent by US to slow rising powers:

Tariffs were ~~try~~ used to slow the economic momentum of rising powers, particularly China, by making their exports less competitive in U.S market, which is a realist strategy to prevent rivals from gaining relative advantage without military conflict.

2.9 Limiting China's Belt and Road Initiative BRI Influence:

Tariffs and sanctions signal other countries that siding economically with China may carry risks, which counters China's rise as a global power.

Date: Day:

Conclusion:

The US reliance on tariffs and trade restrictions under Trump was aimed at maintaining strategic primacy and constraining the rise of competitors, particularly China.